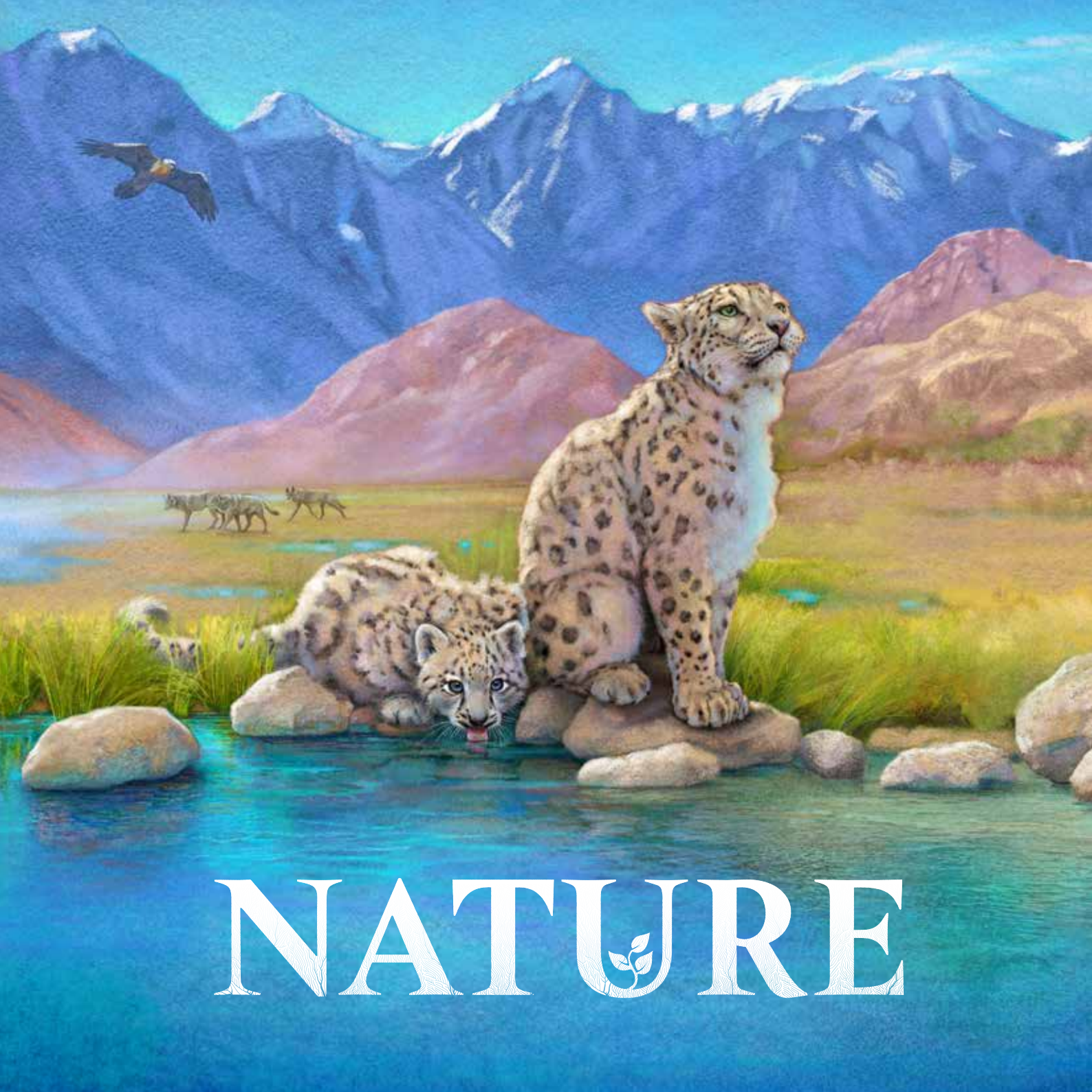

NATURE

Nature is bursting with life!

Earth is home to millions of species - plants, fungi, insects, birds, reptiles, and mammals - each with an innate drive to grow and flourish.

The game of *Nature* simulates a dynamic ecosystem around a small watering hole. The goal is to grow your population while navigating two threats: starvation and predation. Strategically adapt to the changing environment and your species will flourish and thrive, but adapt poorly and your population will dwindle. There are thousands of unique species to discover.

Welcome to the incredible diversity of *Nature*!

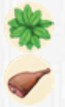


Skip the rules! Scan to go digital

COMPONENTS



Population
The goal of *Nature* is to have a flourishing population. Population represents animals that need to be fed and protected.



Food
Every population needs food. There are two types of food: plant and meat . Each food that sustains a population for a round will be worth 1 point at the end of the game.



Player Screens
Place your food / behind your player screen (or in your deluxe player bag) at the end of each round. This keeps the score hidden until the end of the game.



Watering Hole
The watering hole is the only place for animals to eat plants . A limited number of plants are added each round, so get to the watering hole before the food runs out!



Hunter Cards
Any player can use a *hunter* card to turn their species into a hunter. A hunter no longer eats plants from the watering hole. Instead, it eats meat by hunting animals around the watering hole.



Size Dials
Every species has a size dial to keep track of its size. Larger species eat more food when they feed at the watering hole, and are better defended against hunters.



Nature Cards
There are 8 different traits in the *Nature* deck. These traits are superpowers that allow your species to adapt to the changing environment as they struggle to survive and thrive.



Snow Leopard
One of the most awesome first player markers in evolutionary history.



Solo Cards
These cards are only used when you play *Nature Solo*. Each card represents an opponent's species with a unique personality.

SETUP

1. Place the watering hole on the table.
2. Place the size dials on opposite sides of the table.
3. Place the population next to the size dials.
4. Place the food trays with plant and meat near the watering hole.
5. Shuffle the *Nature* cards and place them face-down to form the *Nature* deck.
6. Place the *Hunter* cards near the watering hole.
7. Give a player screen (or a deluxe player bag) to each player.
8. The person who can make the most amazing animal noise goes first. Give them the snow leopard.
9. A set amount of food will be added to the watering hole at the start of each round. Draw the top card of the *Nature* deck, then multiply the food number shown (in the bottom right corner) by the number of players. This is the amount of plants that will be added to the watering hole each round. Tuck the card under the watering hole to remind you how much food to add in future rounds.

Player Count	Card Number 1	2	3	4
Solo	2	4	6	8
2-Players	2	4	6	8
3-Players	3	6	9	12
4-Players	4	8	12	16



Note: If it is your first game, use a card with a food number of 3.



PLAYING NATURE

GOAL

The goal of *Nature* is to grow your population in an ever-changing ecosystem where food is scarce and predators lurk. You will receive 1 point for every population you keep alive each round. To track this, you will place the food eaten by your population behind your player screen (or in your deluxe player bag) at the end of each round.

At the end of the game, you will score:

- 1 point for every plant and every meat behind your player screens (or in your deluxe player bag).
- 2 points for each of your surviving species as a Game End Bonus.

GAME STRUCTURE

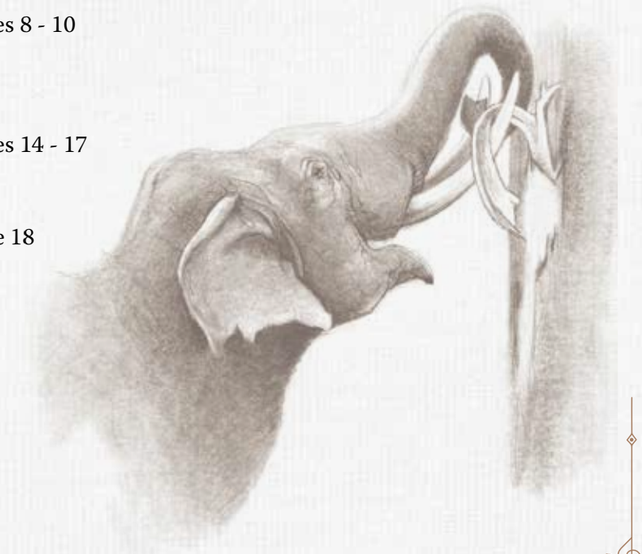
Nature is played over four rounds. In each round, go through the following steps:

Preparation: . . . . . Page 7
Add Food to the Watering Hole
Get a New Species
Draw 5 Cards

Adapting Phase: . . . . . Pages 8 - 10
Play Cards
Free Actions
Reveal Traits

Feeding Phase: . . . . . Pages 14 - 17
Feeding Actions
Free Actions

Scoring: . . . . . Page 18



PREPARATION

1. ADD PLANTS

Add the number of plants determined during setup (page 4) to the watering hole. These are in addition to any plants that might be leftover from the previous round.

2. NEW SPECIES

Every round, each player takes the following:

- A size dial showing size 1
- A population

The size dial represents the physical size of the animals and the population represents the number of animals that need to be fed each round. Place the size dial forager side up to show that it takes the **forage** action when feeding.

Lost Population

If you lost population → in the previous round, add all lost population to your new species. For example, if 3 of your population were **killed** in the previous round, your new species will start with 4 population .

Lost Size

If your species became extinct in the previous round, add the lost size to your new species.

For example, if a size 3 species went extinct, your new species will start at size 4. Or if you lost two size 1 species in the previous round, your new species will start at size 3.

Lost size in excess of the largest number on the size dial are lost forever (size 4 in *Nature* and size 10 with the *Jurassic* module).

3. DRAW CARDS

Each player draws 5 cards from the *Nature* deck. There is no maximum hand size, so these 5 cards are in addition to cards that a player may have from a previous round.

If you run out of cards in the *Nature* deck, shuffle the discard pile and make a new *Nature* draw deck.

ADAPTING PHASE

The theme of the Adapting Phase takes place over millions of years as species adapt to the changing environment. Each player only gets one turn during this phase, so plan ahead!

PLAY CARDS

The player with the snow leopard is the first player to take their turn. Each card in your hand can be used for the following actions:

- **Increase Population**
- **Increase Size**
- **Play a Trait**

On your turn, you may play as many cards as you like. Each action can be taken multiple times and in any order.

Increase Population

Take any card from your hand and place it face-up in the discard pile, then take a population from the supply and add it to any one of your species. There is no limit to the number of population a species can have.

Tip: The goal of Nature is to grow your population. You score points for keeping them alive each round.

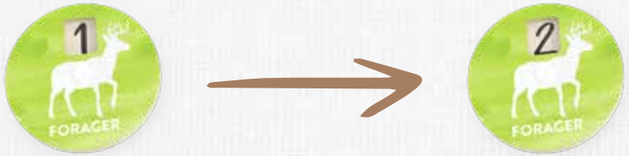




Increase Size

Take any card from your hand and place it face-up in the discard pile, then increase the size of any one of your species by rotating the size dial to the next number. The maximum size on the *Nature* size dial is 4, roughly the size of a rhinoceros, moose, or elephant.

Tip: A larger species **eats** plants more quickly, allowing it to **eat** the limited food before the other animals.



The size of a species determines how effective it is at hunting, defending, and foraging. These are explained in the Feeding Phase section (page 14 - 17).

Play a Trait

Take any card from your hand and play it face-down above any one of your species. This card is now a trait that will modify that species once it is flipped face-up. The maximum number of traits a species can have is 3. You may play several of the same traits to a species, but each copy counts towards the 3 trait maximum.

Tip: Every trait is powerful, but they are most powerful when combined with traits that synergize well.



FREE ACTIONS

Free actions allow you to adapt your species without playing a card from your hand. Free actions may be taken multiple times and at any time during your Adapting Phase turn.

Become a Hunter

You may play a *Hunter* card as a trait on any of your species. The *Hunter* trait counts toward the 3 trait limit. The number of available *Hunter* cards is unlimited, so use a proxy card if the pile runs out.

When you play a *Hunter* trait, flip over the size dial of that species to show that it can **hunt**. It can no longer **forage** for plants in the watering hole.



Sam wants to make his species a hunter. He takes a Hunter card from the stack and adds it as his third trait. He then flips his size dial to show that his species is now a hunter.

Remove Traits

You may discard traits from any of your species to make room for a different trait. Return *Hunter* traits to the *Hunter* deck and place other removed traits in the face-up discard pile. When you remove the *Hunter* card, flip your size dial back to the forager side. It can no longer **hunt** other species.

Hold Cards

You may keep 1 or more cards to play as food during the Feeding Phase, or to play in the next round.

Tip: Hold a card to add food to the watering hole if you think the food will be gone before your first feeding turn.

REVEAL TRAITS

The Adapting Phase ends when every player has taken one turn. Flip all of the face-down traits so they are face-up and move into the Feeding Phase.

ABOUT TRAITS

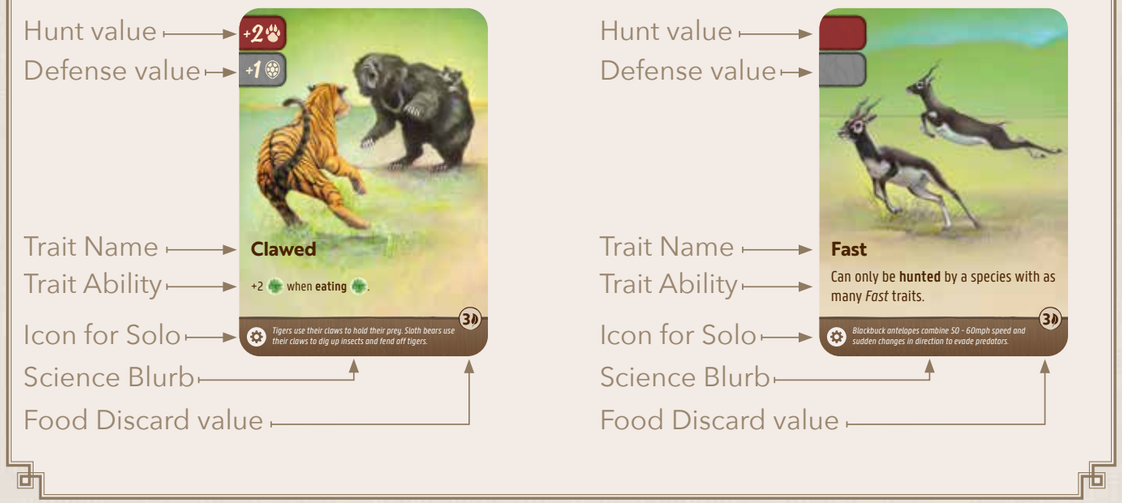
Traits are played on a species to modify the ability of that species. The rules on a trait card override the core *Nature* rules. Any combination of up to 3 traits can be played on forager or a hunter, but 3 traits is the maximum number of traits a species can have.

HUNT VALUE AND DEFENSE VALUE

The hunt value and defense value of a species is equal to the number on its size dial, but can be increased by trait cards.

In the top left of each trait, the value in the red tab adds to the species hunt value, while the value in the grey tab adds to the defense value. If these tabs hold no values, nothing is added.

TRAIT CARDS



TRIGGER TRAITS

Traits with an exclamation point ⚠ are trigger traits. They have a mandatory ability that gets activated when the trigger condition is met. The ability will activate anytime the condition is met, regardless of whose turn it is.



Scavenging triggers anytime a species **hunts**. It may trigger on your turn or someone else's turn. When *Scavenging* triggers, the species **eats** 2 meat from the supply. Remember: you must have hungry population to **eat food**.

Opportunistic triggers on your turn, if there is plant in the watering hole after one of your species **forages** or **hunts**. When *Opportunistic* triggers, the species **eats** 2 meat from the supply.

Tusked triggers anytime the watering hole becomes empty. It may trigger on your turn or someone else's turn. When *Tusked* triggers, the species **eats** 1 meat from the supply.

HERBIVORE

When a new species enters play at the start of the round, it is a Herbivore. It may **eat** plants when it **forages** from the watering hole.

OMNIVORE

If a trigger trait is added to the species, it becomes an Omnivore. It may still **forage** to **eat** plants from the watering hole, but it will also **eat** meat if the trigger trait activates.

CARNIVORE

If a *Hunter* trait is added to the species, it becomes a Carnivore. It may no longer **forage** from the watering hole to **eat** plants. It **hunts** to **eat** meat instead.

EXAMPLES OF SPECIES



This size 1 species has 2 population, a Fast trait, a Plated trait, and a face-down trait. The face-down trait will get revealed at the end of the Adapting Phase. It has a defense value of 5: 1 defense from its size +4 defense from Plated.



*This size 2 species has 3 population, a Social trait, and a Fast trait. It would normally **eat** 2 plants when **foraging** from the watering hole because of its size, but because of Social, it will **eat** 4 plants. If this species was a hunter, Social would allow it to take 2 additional meat from the supply when it **hunts**.*



This size 3 species has 3 population, a Hunter trait, and a Clawed trait. Its hunt value is 5: 3 from its size and +2 from Clawed.

FEEDING PHASE

The Feeding Phase is a snapshot of the ecosystem at a specific point in time. Each player will get multiple turns during the Feeding Phase to feed their species.

IMPORTANT DEFINITIONS

This is a hungry population; . It does not have plant or meat on it.

These are fed population; / .

When a population is **killed**, flip it over; →

At the start of the Feeding Phase, every population is hungry. Starting with the player who has the snow leopard and moving clockwise around the table, each player will take a feeding turn to feed <u>one</u> of their species.

The Feeding Phase will end when every population is fed or dead:

- fed ..... or
- **killed** by **starvation**.....
- **killed** in a **hunt**.....

FEEDING TURNS

On your turn, you must take the first possible action out of the following:

1. Take a feeding action with a hungry species.
2. If you cannot take a feeding action, then **starve** 1 hungry population .
3. If you don't have any hungry population, you must **pass**.

The Feeding Phase ends once everyone has **passed**.



Forage Feeding Action

A forager may take the **forage** feeding action as long as it will get food from the action. When a species **forages**, it **eats** plants from the watering hole equal to its size, plus any additional amount indicated by its traits. Place each **eaten** plant on top of a hungry population .

A species must always **eat** the full amount unless:

- **There are not enough plants in the watering hole.**
  Plant food is limited to the number of plants in the watering hole. If a species can **forage** for 4, but there are only 2 plants in the watering hole, then it will only **eat** 2 plants when it **forages**.
- **Your species does not have enough hungry population .**
  A species may never **eat** more food than it has hungry population . If your species can **forage** for 4, but it only has 1 hungry population , then it will only **eat** 1 plant when it **forages**, and the remaining 3 will stay in the watering hole.



*Jeffrey has a size 1 species with 4 population . It **eats** 3 plants when it **forages**; 1 plant for its size and 2 plants because of the* Clawed *trait. Jeffrey takes 3 plants from the watering hole and places them on 3 hungry population . One of its population is still hungry, so Jeffrey will have to wait to feed this species again on a subsequent turn. Hopefully, there will still be food in the watering hole!*

Hunt Feeding Action



A species that received a *Hunter* trait during the Adapting Phase is a hunter. Hunters can take the **hunt** feeding action before or after the watering hole runs out of plants.

A hunter may **hunt** another species if the hunter:

- is hungry.
- has a hunt value equal to or greater than the defense value of its prey.
- can overcome the defense traits of its prey (such as *Fast*).

After a successful **hunt**:

1. The hunter **kills** 1 population of the hunted species. The player who controls the hunted species chooses which population to flip over. This dead population will get flipped back to the living side and added to their new species at the start of the next round.
2. If the population that was **killed** had a food token on it, return the food to the supply.
3. The hunter **eats** meat from the supply equal to the size of the hunted species. Place each **eaten** meat on top of a hungry population of the hunter. Any extra meat remains in the supply.

A hungry hunter must **hunt** if there is available prey, regardless of who controls that species. For example, your hunter must **hunt** a species with the *Horned* trait, even if that that species belong to you!



Dom's species has a hunt value of 5: 3 for its size and +2 from Clawed. *Maddie's species has a defense value of 5: 3 for its size and +2 from* Tusked, *so Maddie's species is a legal target for the* ***hunt****.*

Maddie flips over one population from the hunted species. It will be added to Maddie's new species next round. Dom's species ***eats*** *3 meat because Maddie's species is size 3. He takes them from the supply and places them on three of his hungry population. Dom will need to feed his 2 remaining hungry population on a future turn.*

Starving

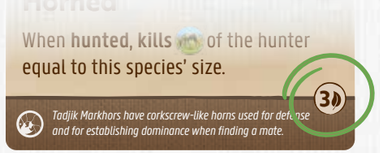
If you are unable to **forage** or **hunt** with any of your species, you must choose 1 hungry population to **starve**. Flip over the population → to show it was **killed**. It will be added to your new species at the beginning of the next round. If this is the species' last population, it has become extinct. See Extinction below.

Passing

On your turn you must **pass** if you don't feed any of your species and you don't have any hungry population to **starve**. Once you **pass**, your turn will be skipped for the remainder of the Feeding Phase.

FREE ACTION

Before taking a feeding action (**foraging**, **hunting**, **starving**, or **passing**), you may discard one or more cards from your hand to add plants to the watering hole. Add plants equal to the food value(s) indicated in the bottom right corner of the discarded card(s).



EXTINCTION

A species goes extinct when its last population is **killed** or **starves**. Do the following if one of your species goes extinct:

- Place its **killed** population and its size dial next to your player screen. They will be added to your new species next round. See Preparation on page 7.
- If the species had a *Hunter* trait, return it to the *Hunter* deck.
- Return its other trait(s) to your hand. These cards are available immediately, which means you can discard them to add food to the watering hole during the current Feeding Phase.

Reminder: There is no maximum hand size. You will get 5 additional cards during Preparation in the next round.



SCORING

Remove the plant and meat from your fed population / and place them behind your player screen. They will each be worth 1 point at the end of the game.

If there are plants remaining in the watering hole, leave them there. You will add additional plants next round during Preparation.

The game ends after Round 4. If this is the end of Round 4, proceed to the Game End section. Otherwise, pass the awesome snow leopard to the left and begin a new round, starting with Preparation.

GAME END

To determine the success of your species in *Nature*, each player scores:

- 1 point for every plant and every meat behind their player screen (or in their deluxe player bag).
- 2 points as a Game End Bonus for each surviving species.

The player with the most points wins.

If there is a tie, the player with the most traits on their surviving species wins. If there is still a tie, order two pizzas—a vegetarian and a meat lovers—and play again!

Join the community
Vote for future modules
Get free stuff



NATURE GAME SYSTEM

The core game of *Nature* is a stand-alone experience with a surprising amount of strategic depth.

The *Nature* game system allows you to alter that experience by adding one or more modules. We recommend playing each module on its own before mixing them together. You can add one Location module to change the biome of the ecosystem, along with as many other modules as you like. When you add one or more modules to *Nature*, play five rounds instead of four. Every combination creates a unique environment to discover!

Each *Nature* module is designed for a unique style of play. A module might add bluffing or dramatic events, favor aggressive strategies, or reward players who avoid conflict. You can learn more about the *Nature* modules at NorthStarGames.com.

VARIABLE LENGTH

You can play additional rounds to *Nature* if you'd like a longer game. Each additional round adds about 20 minutes to the game. Adding several modules and 2 rounds turns *Nature* into an epic 2 hour game!

QUICK PLAY VARIANT

In this variant, everyone plays their cards during the Adapting Phase simultaneously, without looking at what actions their opponents are taking. This variant can be chaotic, but it more closely represents how random mutations drive evolution through natural selection.

5-6 PLAYER RULES

You can play with up to 6 players if you have the *Nature* Big Box edition (or two copies of *Nature*). Play with the Quick Play Variant to minimize downtime.



FAQ

What happens if we run out of a component?
Components are unlimited. Use something in its place such as a coin, a die, or a plastic miniature you never use from an expensive Kickstarter campaign.

Can I choose to eat less food than the written amount?
No, but sometimes your species will not **eat** the full amount because it does not have enough hungry population.

Can I add the lost and size from the previous round to any species?
No, they must be added to your new species.

Do I get anything for the card I lose if I discard a trait from my species?
No.

During the Feeding Phase, can I discard traits from my species to add food to the watering hole?
No, a discarded card must come from your hand.

If my size 4 species goes extinct, does my new species come in the next round at size 5?
No. The maximum size is indicated on the size dial. In *Nature*, the largest number on the size dial is 4.

Who chooses which population is killed when a species is hunted?
The player controlling the species that lost a population chooses which population is **killed**. It may be a hungry population or a fed population /.

Can I hold onto cards I kept in my hand from one round to the next?
Yes. Any saved cards are added to the 5 cards you draw at the beginning of the next round. There is no limit to your hand size.

What happens when I remove a trait that turned my species into a hunter?
Flip over the size dial. The species is now a forager. It cannot **hunt**.

Is a triggered ability optional?
No. The ability happens every time the trigger condition is met. The word "may" is needed to make something optional.

Can I look through the discard pile?
No, you can only look at the top card of the discard pile. When someone plays cards to the discard, they play them 1 at a time, giving everyone a chance to see which cards were discarded.

THE HISTORY OF NATURE

Our story begins with Darwin's revolutionary theory of evolution: that random mutations shaped by natural selection over millions of years, have led to the incredible diversity of life on Earth. Inspired by this concept, Russian biologist Dmitry Knorre created a scientific game as a gift for friends, which eventually became *Evolution: The Origin of Species*.



Dmitry's game served as the foundation for the international award-winning hit *Evolution*, which gained recognition from *Nature*, the world's leading scientific journal.

nature International weekly journal of science

"Evolution features sophisticated biology. Traits can be put together in a dizzying array of combinations, so each game can be very different. The theme of evolution is not just tacked on: it drives play."

– Stuart West, Professor of Evolutionary Biology, University of Oxford

The *Nature* article sparked widespread interest, with other scientific journals highlighting the game and hundreds of universities and schools adopting it as a teaching tool. It was a dream come true to see *Evolution* bridging science and game design, but its widespread use also revealed opportunities for improvement.

With over a decade of experience designing the *Evolution* series, Dominic Crapuchettes completely reimagined the game from the ground up. The result is *Nature*—a streamlined, engaging, and endlessly expandable system that allows players to craft and discover limitless ecosystems.

"If I have seen further, it is by standing on the shoulders of giants." - Sir Isaac Newton

Free to Try on Phone or Tablet!

Download the free app for a cutting-edge interactive tutorial—the simplest way to learn the game and its modules.

Explore an extensive solo campaign against AI that learns from every game. Challenge friends via online matchmaking, pass and play, and more.

Scan the QR code below, then enter code **NAT56A61** to receive exclusive digital goodies and in-game content:



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Illustrations . . . . . Catherine Hamilton

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OUR SUSTAINABILITY PLEDGE

All Versions of Nature are Completely Biodegradable

Creating a new game about nature inspired us to minimize our environmental impact. Instead of plastic, we made *Nature* biodegradable, using paper storage, wooden dice, and polylactic acid for spinner pins. We believe small steps like these help contribute to a larger solution for climate change.

–Sam Sanders, *Head of Operations*



NORTHSTAR TEAM

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